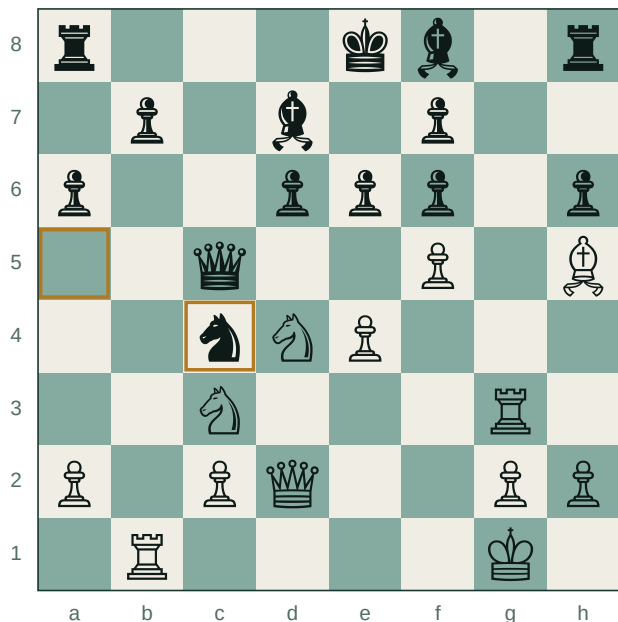


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 20

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 19...Nc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20. Qf2 e5 21. Ne6 Qxf2+ 22. Kxf2

20.Qf2 The queen moves from d2 to f2. Recorded reply: **20...e5**.

21.Ne6 The knight moves from d4 to e6. From e6 it attacks queen on c5 and bishop on f8. Recorded reply: **21...Qxf2+**.

22.Kxf2 The king captures the queen on f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: pawn on f7.